Gielo Joseph Fernandez

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Visa: Post Study Work Visa (Until May 2029)

Professional Summary

- Full-Stack Software Developer with 6+ years of experience building web applications and internal tooling using JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Node.js, and SQL. Strong experience in API development, database design, and automation. Passionate about building systems that make teams more effective and scalable. Proven track record of optimizing performance by 25% and delivering solutions for enterprise platforms serving 10,000+ users. Available to start in 2 weeks with full NZ work rights until 2029.

Key Highlights

- **Impact:** 20+ hours saved via automation — 25% faster page loads — 4x map performance — 10+ hours saved per release
- **Internal Tooling & Automation:** ETL Pipelines, Automation Scripts, Dashboards, Process Improvement, Data Processing
- **Troubleshooting & Support:** Technical Troubleshooting, System Log Analysis, Incident Resolution, Defect Tracking
- **Tech Expertise:** JavaScript, TypeScript, React, React Native (familiar), Node.js, SQL Server, REST APIs, GraphQL
- **AI-Assisted Development:** GitHub Copilot, Replit AI, ChatGPT/Claude, Cursor (familiar)
- **Availability:** Available to start in 2 weeks — Full NZ work rights until 2029

Experience

- **Manulife / John Hancock** — Makati, Philippines
  Full Stack Software Engineer — *Aug. 2021 – Sept. 2024*
  - **Full-Stack Architecture**: Developed and deployed enterprise-grade features across microservices, REST APIs, and React-based UIs, with backend services built using Node.js. Served 10,000+ policyholders on a transactional insurance platform. https://www.coverme.com/travel-insurance/get-a-quote
  - **Technical Troubleshooting & Operations**: Identified, documented, and resolved technical issues across microservices and APIs. Used system log analysis to diagnose root causes and drive resolution.
  - **ETL & Data Engineering**: Engineered daily ETL pipelines processing $10,000+ in financial transactions, implementing reconciliation logic that eliminated force-balance errors and achieved 99.99% data accuracy.
  - **Client Support & Maintenance**: Managed website support tickets and performed routine maintenance, resolving client-reported issues and implementing feature enhancements.
  - **Responsive Web Development**: Built responsive, accessible user interfaces for enterprise insurance platform, ensuring consistent experience across all devices and browsers.
  - **Agile Leadership**: Served as acting Scrum Master for a cross-functional team, facilitating sprint planning, daily stand-ups, and retrospectives.
- **Orcas Consulting Ltd.** — Raglan, New Zealand
  Software Engineer Intern — *Nov. 2025 – Feb. 2026*
  - **Internal Tooling & Automation**: Engineered Python-based ETL pipelines to automate manual data collection, eliminating 20+ hours of manual work. Built automation scripts and internal tooling to replace repetitive processes.
  - **Industrial Data Platform (Time-Series Analytics)**: Built a data platform for marine location analytics, processing time-series tidal data for forecasting applications. Available at: https://www.rippleforecast.com/tide

- **Data Engineering & ETL Pipelines**: Engineered Python-based ETL pipelines to scrape and process structured data from third-party sources.
- **Optimized Map function loading speed by 4x**: Optimized data visualization by implementing Map Marker Clustering, achieving 4x faster rendering for thousands of real-time data points.
- **Reduced File Storage Size by over 90%**: Converted large time-series GEO-JSON datasets into compressed ZARR format, reducing storage by 90% and improving retrieval efficiency.
- **AI-Assisted Development & Testing**: Leveraged Replit AI and GitHub Copilot to accelerate development and testing cycles, cutting prototype turnaround times by 40%.

- **Evidentful** — Cromwell, New Zealand
  Junior AI Engineer Intern — *Dec. 2024 – Mar. 2025*
  - **AI-Powered Testing & Search Solutions**: Built proof-of-concept for AI-powered search using hybrid keyword and vector retrieval. Applied AI-driven approaches to data discovery and natural language query processing.
  - **Data Processing Workflows**: Implemented vector search workflows to improve the system's ability to process and retrieve information from natural language queries.
  - **Containerization & Deployment**: Containerized applications using Docker to ensure consistent development, testing, and deployment environments.

- **Denso Ten Solutions** — Pasig City, Philippines
  Software Quality Engineer — *Aug. 2018 – July 2021*
  - **Technical Troubleshooting**: Identified, documented, and tracked software defects using Eclipse and system log tracking tools. Provided clear feedback to developers for timely resolution.
  - **Manual & Automated Testing**: Designed and executed comprehensive test cases for automotive ECU components, ensuring 100% test coverage and compliance with functional safety requirements.
  - **Test Automation**: Engineered MATLAB-based scripts to automate test input generation and output validation, improving test coverage and verification accuracy by 30%.
  - **Quality Documentation**: Authored comprehensive test documentation and system configuration guides, reducing troubleshooting times by 40%.

Projects

- **RippleForecast Tides (Internship Project, 2026)**: Built a time-series data platform processing tidal data for forecasting applications. Engineered Python ETL pipelines, optimized large datasets, and delivered real-time visualizations. https://www.rippleforecast.com/tide
- **CoverMe Travel Insurance (Enterprise Project, 2023)**: Full-stack transactional platform with React/TypeScript frontend serving 10,000+ policyholders. Implemented responsive UI, state management, and performance optimization. https://www.coverme.com/travel-insurance/get-a-quote
- **SQL Analytics Dashboard (Personal Project, 2026)**: Designed relational databases and built interactive dashboards using Streamlit for data visualization. https://gielofernandez-sql-project.streamlit.app/

Education

- **Future Skills Academy International** — Auckland, New Zealand
  Master of Applied Management; Major in Business Information Systems — *Oct. 2024 – Apr. 2026*
- **University of Santo Tomas** — Manila, Philippines
  Bachelor of Science in Computer Science — *June 2012 – July 2017*

Technical Skills

- **Internal Tooling & Automation**: ETL Pipelines, Automation Scripts, Dashboards, Process Improvement, Data Processing
- **Troubleshooting & Support**: System Log Analysis, Incident Resolution, Technical Troubleshooting, Defect Tracking, Jira, Confluence

- **Frontend**: React, React Native (familiar), Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS, SCSS, Tailwind CSS (familiar), Responsive UI
- **Backend & Data**: Node.js, REST APIs, GraphQL, Python, SQL Server, T-SQL, ETL Pipelines, Data Processing
- **Databases**: SQL Server, T-SQL, Stored Procedures, Query Optimization, NoSQL, CosmosDB, Time-Series Data
- **DevOps & Cloud**: Microsoft Azure (AZ-900 Certified), AWS (familiar), Docker, Git, CI/CD Pipelines
- **AI & Emerging Tech**: GitHub Copilot, Replit AI, ChatGPT/Claude, Cursor (familiar), AI-Assisted Development
- **Methodologies**: Agile, Scrum (Scrum Master), Jira, Confluence, Full SDLC

Certifications & Languages

- **Certifications:** Datacamp AI Fundamentals (2025), Microsoft Certified Azure Fundamentals AZ-900 (2023), AutoCAD Training (2018)
- **Languages:** English (Fluent), Japanese (JLPT N4), Korean (Basic)